



WHAT CONNECTS US B2

Reading for the main idea and more — bridging the generation gap



HERE'S WHAT YOU'LL BE ABLE TO DO

- Understand what the article is mainly about
- Find the most important facts and mistakes
- Tell the difference between facts and opinions
- Write a reflection on the reading theme



LET'S GET STARTED

**WHAT DO THESE TWO PEOPLE HAVE IN COMMON?
WHAT MAKES THEM DIFFERENT?**



IMPORTANT WORDS

generation gap

/ˌdʒenə'reɪʃn ɡæp/

*There is a big **generation gap** between old people and young people.*

A green smartphone is lying horizontally on a light-colored wooden surface. The phone is positioned in the middle ground, slightly out of focus. The background is blurred, showing indistinct shapes and colors. The text 'frustration' is written in a bold, yellow, sans-serif font above the phone. Below it, the phonetic transcription '/frʌ'streɪʃn/' is written in a white, italicized, serif font. Further down, a sentence is written in a white, italicized, serif font, with the word 'frustration' highlighted in yellow. The overall lighting is soft and natural, suggesting an indoor setting with ambient light.

frustration

/frʌ'streɪʃn/

*I felt **frustration** when my phone died during an important call.*

A young man with short, light brown hair and a light beard is standing in a modern office. He is wearing a dark blue blazer over a light blue checkered shirt. His arms are crossed, and he is looking directly at the camera with a serious expression. The office has large windows in the background, and the lighting is soft and even.

redefine

/ˌriːdɪˈfaɪn/

*The new CEO wants to **redefine** success in our company.*

A photograph of a modern home office desk. On the desk is a silver laptop with a black screen, a white coffee cup on a saucer, a small framed photo of a woman, and a glass of milk. Two pens are also on the desk. The background is a plain white wall. The entire image is overlaid with a semi-transparent grey filter.

workplace

/'wɜ:kpleɪs/

*The **workplace** is changing. Now more people work from home.*



WHAT'S THE MAIN IDEA?

Look at the main reading, the photos and the headlines.

What do you think the text is about?



FINDING DETAILS

We're now going to read the story in more detail.

Let's start with some True/False questions.

They may look easy, but they can have some surprises!



TRUE/FALSE STRATEGY

"The author wrote the text to explore the generation gap and problems it can cause, and to suggest a possible solution."

Step 1: Read the statement carefully.

Sometimes there is more than one question to think about — note each part separately.

Step 2: Work out what the question is asking

- Did the author write about the generation gap? (Yes/No)
- Did the author write about the problems it can cause? (Yes/No)
- Did the author suggest a possible solution? (Yes/No)

Rule: Yes to all → TRUE · No to any → FALSE

Step 3: Find the evidence

Keywords in paras A + F: "*generation gap*" · "*empathy*" · "*solution*"

Step 4: Answer the question

"The author wrote the text to explore the generation gap..."

- generation gap → *"called the generation gap"*
- problems → *"This can lead to frustration for everyone"*
- solution → *"listen to the people around us...with empathy"*

Answer: TRUE



TRUE/FALSE — YOUR TURN

Complete Exercise 2, items 2 and 3.

Use the strategy we just learned.

EXERCISE 2 — ANSWERS

Question	Answer	Why?
<i>The main idea is that it is almost impossible for people from different generations to understand one another.</i>	X	The article says people <i>can</i> understand each other through empathy. The gap is real, but it is not impossible to bridge.
<i>The text does not inform or teach us, because its purpose is to persuade and influence.</i>	X	The text informs and teaches. It explains what the generation gap is, the problems it causes, and a possible solution.



MATCHING IDEAS

Now let's match the main ideas to the right paragraphs.
Each statement matches one paragraph — find the best fit.



PARAGRAPH MATCHING STRATEGY

"The generation gap affects people in their job because it means that people of different ages working together may have very different opinions."

Step 1: Read the statement

Find the **main topic**: job + people of different ages + different opinions →
workplace conflict

Step 2: Find keywords

- *"people in their job"*
- *"different ages working together"*
- *"different opinions"*

Step 3: Scan paragraphs A–F

- Look for keywords: "*workplace*", "*different expectations*", "*frustration*" → **Paragraph B**

Step 4: Confirm the match

- B says: *"As young employees enter companies, they may have completely different expectations... This can lead to frustration for everyone."*
- The whole statement matches — not just one word.
- **Answer: B**



PARAGRAPH MATCHING — YOUR TURN

Complete Exercise 3. Match statements 1–6 to paragraphs A–F.

Use the strategy we just learned.



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EXERCISE 3 — ANSWERS (1–2)

Statement	Answer	Why?
<i>The generation gap affects people in their job because it means that people of different ages working together may have very different opinions.</i>	B	Para B: young employees have different expectations → frustration
<i>The writer suggests a change in thinking: choosing to see other generations as working with you rather than against you.</i>	C	Para C: "we can see both generations as being on the same side"

EXERCISE 3 — ANSWERS (3–4)

Statement	Answer	Why?
<i>The generation gap is the difference between the way older and younger people see the world.</i>	A	Para A: "difference in attitudes and lack of understanding"
<i>It is a good idea to get to know people who are not your age, and to hear what they think.</i>	E	Para E: "try to socialize with people who are both younger and older"

EXERCISE 3 — ANSWERS (5–6)

Statement	Answer	Why?
<i>The generation gap is not necessarily just a problem; it can also be a great opportunity for learning.</i>	F	Para F: "a source of learning and growth"
<i>Parents should learn about their children's world and not just say they do not like it.</i>	D	Para D: "parents may need to learn more about technology in their kids' lives"



MAKING CONCLUSIONS

Now let's think about what the writer really wants us to understand. Pay attention to the details...



MULTIPLE CHOICE STRATEGY

Now let's learn how to answer MC questions with an example.

"What is the main message of this article?"

- a) young people are better than older people
- b) technology causes problems between generations
- c) understanding between generations is possible

Step 1: Read the question — Is it asking for detail or main idea?

Step 2: Underline key words

"What is the main message of this article?"

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"What is the main message of this article?"

Step 3: Scan the text — Find where the answer is in the passage

- Detail questions: answer follows the order of the text
- Main idea: think about what the whole text is about
- So what we need to do is look at the photos, headlines, and first line of each paragraph in the whole story.

Step 4: Eliminate wrong answers

Option	Why?
a) young people are better than older people	Too narrow — not the main message of the whole article
b) technology causes problems between generations	Only in paragraph D, not the overall message

Step 5: Confirm your answer

Answer	Why?
c) understanding between generations is possible	Matches the article: <i>“if we truly listen with empathy, differences may make us stronger”</i> (para C) and <i>“a source of learning and growth”</i> (para F)



EXERCISE 4

Decide which statement gives the best conclusion of the article:

- a) Learning and change are both easier for younger people
- b) Technology often causes conflict between young and old
- c) Differences can be good if we take time to understand them

EXERCISE 4 — ANSWER

Option		Why?
a) Learning and change are both easier for younger people	✗	Too narrow — the article is about understanding across generations, not just young people
b) Technology often causes conflict between young and old	✗	Only in paragraph D, not the main conclusion of the whole article
c) Differences can be good if we take time to understand them.	✓	<i>“if we truly listen with empathy, differences may make us stronger” (para C) and “a source of learning and growth” (para F)</i>



LET'S DISCUSS

Now let's talk about how this applies to your life.



LET'S DISCUSS

In pairs, discuss the questions from Exercise 5 using ideas from the article:

1. Think of one or two things you have now that you think your parents wish they had when they were your age.
2. Explain something about yourself or your life that you wish the older generation understood better.
3. Name one or two useful things you've learned from someone in an older generation.



LET'S REVIEW

Let's review what we've learned today.



WHAT YOU CAN DO NOW

- ✓ I can find the main idea
- ✓ I can find important facts
- ✓ I can share my ideas